

Table d'Adrian

N° 02 · RECIPE BOOK · 16 RECIPES · CÔTE D'AZUR & MONACO

Christmas *Dinner*

A long table in winter. Onion soup, a roast, and a last sweet course.

RECIPES BY ADRIAN STEFAN, TABLE D'ADRIAN

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WELCOME

Christmas Dinner

A long table in winter. Onion soup, a roast, and a last sweet course.

This book gathers 16 recipes from Adrian Stefan's kitchen library, grouped the way a meal runs: To begin, Starters, Mains, On the side and Desserts. They are reproduced as written in the library, with the serving size, timings, ingredients, method and a note on plating for each dish.

How to use this book

- Read a recipe through once before you shop. Quantities are in grams and millilitres, oven temperatures in °C.
- Each recipe lists its allergens. Check them against your guests.
- The "Variations & swaps" notes show how a dish can change with the season or the table.

> Not medical advice. Talk to your doctor before changing your diet or training, especially if you have a medical condition or take medication.

About the chef

Adrian Stefan is a private chef on the Côte d'Azur and in Monaco, based in Antibes, cooking for villas, yachts and private dinners. Swiss-trained (EHL), 10+ years, Nutrition certificate, Stanford.

Book a private dinner

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CHAPTER ONE · 3 RECIPES

To begin

Gougères au Comté, Black Pepper 5

Foie Gras Terrine, Muscat & Toasted Brioche 6

Œufs Mimosa, Trout Roe & Tarragon 7

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TO BEGIN

Gougères au Comté, Black Pepper

Serves 8 · Prep 20 min · Cook 30 min

"Burgundy's cheese puffs — crackly outside, molten-savory inside; pipe and freeze trays of them for instant apéros all season."

FROM THE RECIPE NOTES

INGREDIENTS (SERVES 8, ~40 PIECES)

Water — 125 ml	Eggs — 4 (about 220 g)
Whole milk — 125 ml	Comté, finely grated — 150 g
Unsalted butter — 100 g	Black pepper, coarse — 2 g
Fine salt — 4 g	Nutmeg — 0.5 g
Plain flour — 150 g	Extra Comté for tops — 30 g

METHOD

1. Heat oven to 190 °C fan. Bring water, milk, butter and salt to a full boil.
2. Off heat, add flour all at once; beat hard. Return to medium heat and dry the panade 2 min until it films the pan.
3. Transfer to a bowl; cool 3 min. Beat in eggs one at a time until the paste falls from the spatula in a slow V.
4. Beat in Comté, pepper and nutmeg.
5. Pipe 3.5 cm domes onto lined trays; top each with a pinch of extra Comté.
6. Bake 25–30 min without opening the door, until deep golden and hollow-sounding.
7. Serve warm; re-crisp day-old ones at 160 °C for 4 min.

PLATING & SERVICE

Pile in a warm napkin-lined bowl with champagne — they vanish in minutes.

VARIATIONS & SWAPS

Swap Comté for Gruyère or aged Mimolette. Freeze piped raw; bake from frozen adding 5 min.

Allergens: gluten, dairy, eggs

Recipe by Adrian Stefan, Table d'Adrian

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TO BEGIN

Foie Gras Terrine, Muscat & Toasted Brioche

Serves 10 · Prep 45 min · Cook 25 min

"Low-temperature terrine kept blushing pink, perfumed with sweet Muscat — a benchmark luxury course that must be made 3 days ahead."

FROM THE RECIPE NOTES

INGREDIENTS (SERVES 10)

- Duck foie gras, whole lobe, top grade — 600 g
- Fine salt — 8 g
- White pepper — 1.5 g
- Sugar — 2 g
- Muscat de Beaumes-de-Venise — 40 ml
- Cognac — 15 ml
- Brioche loaf — 300 g
- Fleur de sel — 2 g
- Fig jam (to serve) — 80 g

METHOD

1. Temper the lobe 1 h at room temperature until pliable. Separate the two lobes.
2. Butterfly each lobe and pull out the primary veins with tweezers, following them from the base.
3. Season all surfaces evenly with salt, pepper and sugar; sprinkle with Muscat and Cognac. Marinate 12 h covered, chilled.
4. Press the pieces into a 600 ml terrine, packing to exclude air; temper 30 min.
5. Cook in a bain-marie at 90 °C oven to a core of 46 °C (about 20–25 min) — no higher.
6. Pour off excess fat and reserve; press the terrine with 500 g overnight.
7. Melt reserved fat, pour a 3 mm cap over the surface; mature 2–3 days at 2 °C.
8. Slice with a hot dry knife; serve with toasted brioche, fleur de sel and fig jam.

PLATING & SERVICE

One 1.5 cm slice per guest on a cold plate, brioche in a napkin, jam quenelle beside.

VARIATIONS & SWAPS

Swap Muscat for Sauternes or a splash of aged Armagnac. GF guests: serve with toasted GF fruit bread.

Allergens: gluten, dairy, eggs, sulphites

Recipe by Adrian Stefan, Table d'Adrian

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TO BEGIN

Œufs Mimosa, Trout Roe & Tarragon

Serves 6 · Prep 25 min · Cook 10 min

"The bistro egg upgraded — silky yolk cream piped high, popped with trout roe; a one-bite crowd-pleaser for apéro or first course."

FROM THE RECIPE NOTES

INGREDIENTS (SERVES 6)

- Eggs — 9
- Egg yolk (raw, for mayonnaise) — 1 (20 g)
- Dijon mustard — 12 g
- Neutral oil — 130 ml
- White wine vinegar — 8 ml
- Crème fraîche — 30 g
- Tarragon, chopped — 6 g
- Chives, sliced — 6 g
- Trout roe — 50 g
- Espelette pepper — 0.5 g
- Fine salt — 4 g

METHOD

1. Boil the 9 eggs exactly 9 min 30 sec from boiling water; shock in iced water, peel.
2. Make a mayonnaise: whisk raw yolk, mustard, vinegar; stream in oil; season.
3. Halve eggs; sieve the cooked yolks. Set 12 best white halves aside; finely chop the remaining whites.
4. Beat sieved yolks with 90 g mayonnaise, crème fraîche, tarragon and salt to a smooth cream.
5. Pipe the cream in tall rosettes into the 12 halves using a star nozzle.
6. Scatter chopped whites and chives over, crown each with trout roe, dust with Espelette.

PLATING & SERVICE

Two halves per person on a smear of the yolk cream to stop them sliding; serve well chilled.

VARIATIONS & SWAPS

Vegetarian: swap roe for chopped black olives or pickled mustard seeds. Anchovy lovers: fold 10 g anchovy paste into the cream.

Allergens: eggs, fish, mustard

Recipe by Adrian Stefan, Table d'Adrian

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CHAPTER TWO · 3 RECIPES

Starters

Soupe à l'Oignon Gratinée, Comté Croutons 9

Velouté de Champignons, Sherry & Chive Oil 10

Bisque de Langoustine, Cognac & Tarragon 11

Not medical advice. Talk to your doctor before changing your diet or training, especially if you have a medical condition or take medication.

STARTERS

Soupe à l'Oignon Gratinée, Comté Croutons

Serves 6 · Prep 20 min · Cook 90 min

"Deeply caramelised onions deglazed in stages give a mahogany broth that eats like a main — the ultimate cold-night charter opener."

FROM THE RECIPE NOTES

INGREDIENTS (SERVES 6)

- Yellow onions, sliced 3 mm — 1.2 kg
- Unsalted butter — 60 g
- Olive oil — 20 ml
- Plain flour — 20 g
- Dry white wine — 150 ml
- Beef stock (or dark chicken stock) — 1.5 L
- Fresh thyme — 4 sprigs
- Bay leaf — 1
- Baguette, sliced 1.5 cm — 12 slices (200 g)
- Comté, grated — 180 g
- Sherry vinegar — 10 ml
- Fine salt — 6 g
- Black pepper — 2 g

METHOD

1. Melt butter with oil in a heavy pot over medium heat; add onions and 3 g salt. Cook 45–55 min, stirring every 5 min, until deep mahogany — deglaze the fond with 20 ml water whenever it darkens.
2. Stir in flour and cook 2 min to coat.
3. Add wine, reduce by half, then add stock, thyme and bay. Simmer 25 min, skimming.
4. Season with sherry vinegar, remaining salt and pepper; discard herbs.
5. Toast baguette slices at 180 °C for 8 min until dry and golden.
6. Ladle soup into ovenproof bowls, float 2 croutons per bowl, cover generously with Comté.
7. Gratinate under a hot grill (250 °C) 4–5 min until blistered and bubbling.

PLATING & SERVICE

Serve bubbling in lion's-head bowls on underliners with a napkin — warn guests the bowl is hot.

VARIATIONS & SWAPS

GF: use gluten-free baguette and swap flour for rice flour. Lighter: skip the gratin, finish with a Comté tuile on the side.

Allergens: gluten, dairy, sulphites, celery

Recipe by Adrian Stefan, Table d'Adrian

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STARTERS

Velouté de Champignons, Sherry & Chive Oil

Serves 6 · Prep 15 min · Cook 35 min

"A silk-smooth mushroom velouté lifted with dry sherry — pours beautifully tableside over a raw mushroom garnish."

FROM THE RECIPE NOTES

INGREDIENTS (SERVES 6)

- Button mushrooms — 600 g
- Chestnut mushrooms — 300 g
- Shallots, sliced — 120 g
- Unsalted butter — 50 g
- Dry sherry (fino) — 60 ml
- Vegetable stock — 900 ml
- Double cream — 200 ml
- Fine salt — 7 g
- White pepper — 1 g
- Chives — 20 g
- Neutral oil — 60 ml
- Firm button mushrooms for garnish — 3, shaved raw

METHOD

1. Blitz chives with oil 45 sec, warm to 60 °C for 5 min, strain through muslin; reserve chive oil.
2. Sweat shallots in butter over medium heat 5 min without colour.
3. Add sliced mushrooms and salt; cook 12–15 min until their water has evaporated and they begin to catch.
4. Deglaze with sherry, reduce to a glaze, add stock and simmer 15 min.
5. Add cream, return to a simmer, then blend at high speed 2 min and pass through a chinois.
6. Season with white pepper; adjust consistency with stock to a pouring cream texture.
7. Serve at 80 °C with shaved raw mushroom and drops of chive oil.

PLATING & SERVICE

Arrange raw mushroom shavings in the bowl, pour the velouté at table, finish with chive oil beads.

VARIATIONS & SWAPS

Vegan: swap butter for olive oil and cream for oat cream. Luxe: add 5 g dried porcini to the stock.

Allergens: dairy, sulphites

Recipe by Adrian Stefan, Table d'Adrian

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STARTERS

Bisque de Langoustine, Cognac & Tarragon

Serves 6 · Prep 30 min · Cook 75 min

"Roasted shells, a proper flambé and a rice-thickened body — the benchmark bisque, with poached tail meat as garnish."

FROM THE RECIPE NOTES

INGREDIENTS (SERVES 6)

- Langoustines, whole — 1.5 kg
- Olive oil — 40 ml
- Carrot, mirepoix — 100 g
- Onion, mirepoix — 120 g
- Celery, mirepoix — 60 g
- Tomato paste — 40 g
- Cognac — 60 ml
- Dry white wine — 150 ml
- Fish stock — 1.6 L
- Carnaroli rice — 50 g
- Double cream — 150 ml
- Tarragon — 10 g
- Cayenne — 1 g
- Fine salt — 8 g

METHOD

1. Twist off langoustine tails; peel, devein, chill the meat. Reserve heads and shells.
2. Roast shells in oil in a wide pot over high heat 8 min, crushing with a rolling pin end, until deeply toasted.
3. Add mirepoix, cook 6 min; stir in tomato paste and cook 2 min.
4. Add Cognac and flambé; deglaze with wine, reduce by half.
5. Add stock and rice; simmer gently 40 min.
6. Blend shells and all (heavy-duty blender, 2 min), then pass twice through a chinois, pressing hard.
7. Return to heat, add cream, cayenne, salt; hold at 85 °C.
8. Poach tails in the bisque 90 sec before serving; finish with chopped tarragon.

PLATING & SERVICE

Three tails per bowl, bisque poured around, a few tarragon leaves and a thread of cream.

VARIATIONS & SWAPS

Dairy-free: omit cream and mount with 30 ml olive oil. Swap langoustine for crab or prawn shells with equal success.

Allergens: shellfish, dairy, celery, sulphites

Recipe by Adrian Stefan, Table d'Adrian

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CHAPTER THREE · 4 RECIPES

Mains

Poulet Rôti à l'Estragon, Jus Corsé 13

Poulet aux Morilles et Vin Jaune 14

Tournedos Rossini de Fête 15

Turbot Rôti, Beurre Blanc au Champagne 16

Not medical advice. Talk to your doctor before changing your diet or training, especially if you have a medical condition or take medication.

MAINS

Poulet Rôti à l'Estragon, Jus Corsé

Serves 4 · Prep 20 min · Cook 80 min

"The perfect roast chicken, basted with tarragon butter, its pan jus mounted at the last second — simplicity that guests remember over the fireworks."

FROM THE RECIPE NOTES

INGREDIENTS (SERVES 4)

- Whole free-range chicken — 1 (1.6–1.8 kg)
- Unsalted butter, soft — 80 g
- Tarragon — 20 g (12 g chopped, 8 g sprigs)
- Garlic head, halved — 1
- Lemon, halved — 1
- Fine salt — 14 g
- Black pepper — 2 g
- Dry white wine — 100 ml
- Chicken stock — 250 ml
- Shallot, minced — 40 g

METHOD

1. Salt the bird all over, including the cavity, 2–24 h ahead; keep uncovered in the fridge.
2. Work chopped tarragon into 60 g butter; push most under the breast skin, rub the rest outside. Cavity: lemon, garlic, tarragon sprigs. Truss loosely.
3. Roast at 200 °C, one leg down, 20 min; other leg down, 20 min; breast up 20–30 min, basting, until leg core is 80 °C and juices run clear.
4. Rest breast-down on a warm plate 15 min.
5. Jus: pour off fat, sweat shallot in the pan 2 min; add wine, scraping, reduce by half; add stock and resting juices, reduce to 150 ml.
6. Off heat, swirl in remaining 20 g butter; season and strain.
7. Carve; spritz with the roasted lemon.

PLATING & SERVICE

Carved on a warm platter, jus in a small copper pan, frites or green beans amandine beside.

VARIATIONS & SWAPS

Dairy-free: use olive oil under the skin, finish jus unmounted. Swap tarragon for thyme-lemon or sage.

Allergens: dairy, sulphites

Recipe by Adrian Stefan, Table d'Adrian

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MAINS

Poulet aux Morilles et Vin Jaune

Serves 4 · Prep 25 min · Cook 45 min

"The Jura's grandest chicken — breasts poached in a morel and yellow-wine cream that tastes of hazelnut, curry spice and forest floor."

FROM THE RECIPE NOTES

INGREDIENTS (SERVES 4)

- Corn-fed chicken breasts, skin on — 4 (about 200 g each)
- Dried morels — 40 g
- Vin jaune (or dry sherry) — 150 ml
- Shallots, minced — 80 g
- Unsalted butter — 60 g
- Chicken stock — 200 ml
- Double cream — 300 ml
- Lemon juice — 10 ml
- Fine salt — 8 g
- White pepper — 1 g
- Chives — 6 g

METHOD

1. Soak morels in 300 ml warm water 30 min; halve, rinse; strain and reserve 150 ml liquor.
2. Season breasts; colour skin-side down in 30 g butter over medium heat, 6 min, to deep gold; remove.
3. Sweat shallots in remaining butter 3 min; add morels, 3 min more.
4. Deglaze with 120 ml vin jaune; reduce by half. Add stock and morel liquor; reduce by half.
5. Add cream; return chicken skin-up. Simmer gently, uncovered, 15–18 min to a core of 68 °C.
6. Rest chicken; reduce sauce to coat a spoon; finish with remaining 30 ml vin jaune, lemon, seasoning.
7. Slice breasts; sauce and morels over, chives to finish.

PLATING & SERVICE

Fanned breast over the morel cream with fresh tagliatelle or a potato mousseline.

VARIATIONS & SWAPS

Use guinea fowl for more character. Lighter: half cream, half stock reduction — still glossy from the morel gelatine.

Allergens: dairy, sulphites

Recipe by Adrian Stefan, Table d'Adrian

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MAINS

Tournedos Rossini de Fête

Serves 4 · Prep 25 min · Cook 25 min

"Fillet steak on a butter-fried croûte, crowned with seared foie gras and truffled Madeira jus — unapologetic opulence for a celebration night."

FROM THE RECIPE NOTES

INGREDIENTS (SERVES 4)

- Beef fillet tournedos, 4 cm — 4 (160 g each)
- Foie gras slices, 1.5 cm — 4 (60 g each)
- White bread rounds, steak-sized — 4 (100 g)
- Unsalted butter — 80 g
- Neutral oil — 20 ml
- Madeira — 100 ml
- Brown veal stock, reduced — 250 ml
- Black truffle, sliced (or 10 ml truffle jus) — 15 g
- Fine salt — 9 g; black pepper 2 g

METHOD

1. Salt tournedos 30 min ahead. Chill foie gras slices well.
2. Fry bread rounds in 40 g butter until golden both sides; keep warm.
3. Sear tournedos in oil and 20 g butter, 2.5 min per side, basting, to a core of 50 °C; rest on a rack.
4. Jus: deglaze the pan with Madeira, reduce by two-thirds; add stock and truffle; reduce to a glossy nap; mount with remaining butter; season.
5. Score the foie gras; sear in a dry, very hot pan 45 sec per side until mahogany with a molten centre; season, drain on paper.
6. Stack: croûte, tournedos, foie gras; spoon the truffled jus over and around.

PLATING & SERVICE

One tall stack per plate, truffle slices on the jus; pommes purée quenelle beside — nothing green heavier than watercress.

VARIATIONS & SWAPS

Skip the foie for a truffled tournedos au Madère. GF: use a rösti disc instead of the bread croûte.

Allergens: gluten, dairy, sulphites

Recipe by Adrian Stefan, Table d'Adrian

Not medical advice. Talk to your doctor before changing your diet or training, especially if you have a medical condition or take medication.

MAINS

Turbot Rôti, Beurre Blanc au Champagne

Serves 4 · Prep 20 min · Cook 25 min

"Thick tranches of turbot roasted on the bone for gelatinous succulence, with a champagne beurre blanc — the king of flat fish, treated royally."

FROM THE RECIPE NOTES

INGREDIENTS (SERVES 4)

- Turbot tranches on the bone — 4 (about 300 g each)
- Olive oil — 30 ml
- Unsalted butter — 30 g (for roasting)
- Thyme — 3 sprigs
- Fine salt — 8 g
- White pepper — 1 g
- Beurre blanc: shallots, minced — 50 g
- Champagne (or crémant) — 120 ml
- Champagne vinegar — 20 ml
- Double cream — 20 ml
- Cold unsalted butter, diced — 180 g
- Chives, sliced — 8 g
- Lemon juice — 5 ml

METHOD

1. Salt the tranches 20 min ahead; pat dry. Oven to 200 °C.
2. Reduce shallots, champagne and vinegar to 30 ml. Add cream (a stabiliser), reduce 30 sec.
3. Sear tranches dark-skin side down in oil in an ovenproof pan, 3 min; turn, add butter and thyme.
4. Roast 8–12 min depending on thickness, basting once, to a core of 54 °C; flesh should pull from the bone with a nudge.
5. Rest fish 3 min on a rack.
6. Finish the sauce: over low heat, whisk in cold butter cube by cube, never above 60 °C; season with salt, lemon; add chives.
7. Serve fish with the beurre blanc spooned generously alongside.

PLATING & SERVICE

Tranche centred, sauce pooled to one side, a few chives over; steamed ratte potatoes and sea beet complete it.

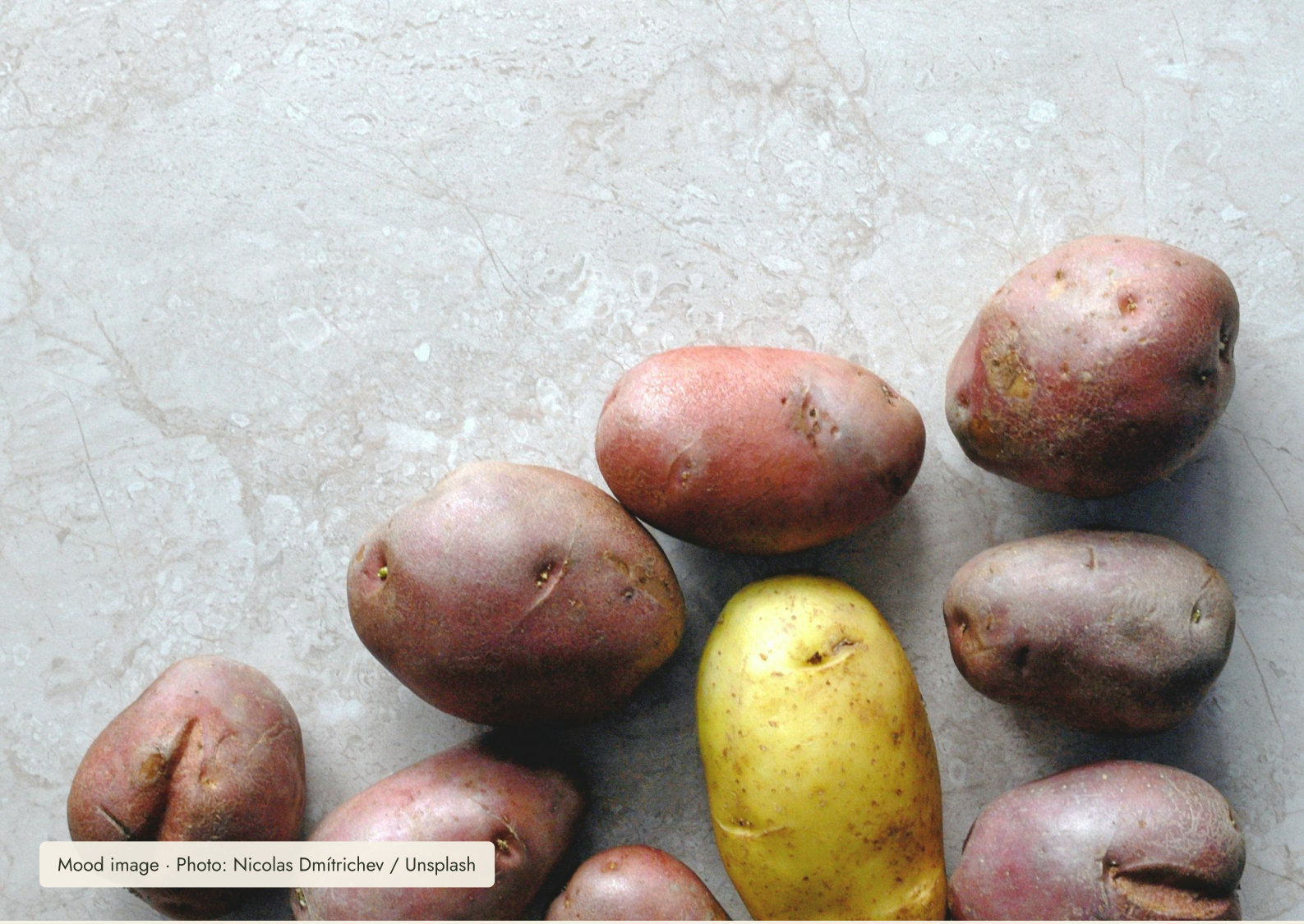
VARIATIONS & SWAPS

Swap champagne for plain white wine any weeknight. Dairy-free: serve with sauce vierge instead of beurre blanc.

Allergens: fish, dairy, sulphites

Recipe by Adrian Stefan, Table d'Adrian

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CHAPTER FOUR · 3 RECIPES

On the side

Gratin Dauphinois à l'Ail 18

Pommes Purée Soyeuse 19

Haricots Verts Amandine 20

Not medical advice. Talk to your doctor before changing your diet or training, especially if you have a medical condition or take medication.

ON THE SIDE

Gratin Dauphinois à l'Ail

Serves 8 · Prep 20 min · Cook 90 min

"No cheese, no eggs — just potatoes lacquered in garlicky cream that reduces in the oven to a custard; the Dauphiné's quiet masterpiece."

FROM THE RECIPE NOTES

INGREDIENTS (SERVES 8)

- Waxy-floury potatoes (Agria/Desiree) — 1.5 kg
- Double cream — 500 ml
- Whole milk — 250 ml
- Garlic — 15 g (10 g simmered, 1 clove for the dish)
- Unsalted butter — 30 g
- Fine salt — 12 g
- White pepper — 1 g
- Nutmeg — 0.6 g
- Bay leaf — 1
- Thyme — 2 sprigs

METHOD

1. Rub a gratin dish with a cut garlic clove; butter it thickly.
2. Peel potatoes; slice 3 mm on a mandoline. DO NOT rinse — the starch binds the cream.
3. Warm cream, milk, sliced garlic, bay, thyme, salt, pepper and nutmeg to 85 °C; infuse 10 min; remove bay and thyme.
4. Layer potatoes flat in the dish, pouring warm cream between layers; finish with cream just reaching the top layer.
5. Press down; bake at 150 °C for 75 min until a knife meets no resistance.
6. Raise to 200 °C for 10–15 min to bronze the top.
7. Rest 15 min — it carves into neat spoonfuls instead of collapsing.

PLATING & SERVICE

Spoon at the table beside roast lamb or bavette; or press overnight, cut into cylinders and re-crisp for plated service.

VARIATIONS & SWAPS

Savoyard heresy (delicious): 100 g Beaufort between layers. Lighter: half milk, half cream — bake 15 min longer.

Allergens: dairy

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ON THE SIDE

Pommes Purée Soyeuse

Serves 6 · Prep 15 min · Cook 40 min

"The haute-cuisine mash — riced twice, mounted with a shameless ratio of cold butter, sieved to silk; the side that upstages the main."

FROM THE RECIPE NOTES

INGREDIENTS (SERVES 6)

- Ratte or Yukon Gold potatoes, even-sized — 1 kg
- Cold unsalted butter, diced — 250 g
- Whole milk — 150 ml
- Fine salt — 12 g
- White pepper — 0.5 g

METHOD

1. Simmer potatoes whole, in their skins, in well-salted water 25–30 min until a knife slides through.
2. Drain; peel while hot, holding them in a cloth.
3. Pass through a ricer twice while still steaming.
4. Return to a heavy pan over low heat; dry the purée 2 min, stirring.
5. Beat in the cold butter a handful at a time — the temperature shock creates the emulsion.
6. Heat the milk to 80 °C; beat in gradually to your preferred looseness.
7. Season; for full silk, force through a fine drum sieve (tamis) with a scraper.
8. Hold in a bain-marie up to 1 h, surface dotted with butter.

PLATING & SERVICE

A tight quenelle or a low pool under braised meat — it should slump slowly, never stand stiff.

VARIATIONS & SWAPS

Civilian ratio: 150 g butter. Olive-oil purée (dairy-free): 120 ml fruity oil and 100 ml potato water instead of butter/milk.

Allergens: dairy

Recipe by Adrian Stefan, Table d'Adrian

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ON THE SIDE

Haricots Verts Amandine

Serves 4 · Prep 10 min · Cook 10 min

"Fine beans blanched to a squeak and rolled in almond brown butter — the little black dress of French sides."

FROM THE RECIPE NOTES

INGREDIENTS (SERVES 4)

- Fine green beans, topped — 500 g
- Unsalted butter — 60 g
- Flaked almonds — 40 g
- Shallot, minced — 30 g
- Lemon juice — 15 ml
- Lemon zest — 2 g
- Fine salt — 12 g (mostly for the blanching water)
- Black pepper — 1 g

METHOD

1. Boil 3 L water with 10 g salt — sea-water salty.
2. Blanch beans 3–4 min: tender but with a whisper of bite. Do not ice if serving immediately — drain hard.
3. Brown the butter with the almonds together over medium heat, 2–3 min, until both are hazelnut-toned.
4. Add shallot to the foaming butter for 30 sec.
5. Off heat, add lemon juice (it will hiss), zest and 2 g salt.
6. Roll the hot beans through the pan to gloss every one; pepper over.

PLATING & SERVICE

A neat parallel bundle or a loose tangle beside trout, chicken or a Sunday roast.

VARIATIONS & SWAPS

Nut-free: toasted breadcrumbs or crisp shallots instead. Vegan: olive oil warmed with almonds, plus a pinch of smoked salt.

Allergens: dairy, nuts

Recipe by Adrian Stefan, Table d'Adrian

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CHAPTER FIVE · 3 RECIPES

Desserts

Tarte Tatin aux Pommes Caramel 22

Mousse au Chocolat Noir 70 Pourcent 23

Mont Blanc aux Marrons, Meringue Croquante 24

Not medical advice. Talk to your doctor before changing your diet or training, especially if you have a medical condition or take medication.

DESSERTS

Tarte Tatin aux Pommes Caramel

Serves 8 · Prep 30 min · Cook 70 min

"Apples cooked standing in a deep dry caramel before the pastry lid goes on — the upside-down icon, flipped hot for a lacquered crown."

FROM THE RECIPE NOTES

INGREDIENTS (SERVES 8)

- Firm apples (Braeburn/Cox/Reine des Reinettes) — 8 (about 1.4 kg)
- Caster sugar — 180 g
- Unsalted butter — 90 g
- Vanilla pod — 1/2
- Lemon juice — 15 ml
- All-butter puff pastry — 300 g
- Fine salt — 1 g
- Crème fraîche, to serve — 200 g

METHOD

1. Peel, halve and core the apples; toss with lemon juice. Roll puff to 4 mm; cut a 26 cm disc; dock; chill.
2. In a 24 cm ovenproof tatin pan, cook the sugar dry to a deep amber caramel.
3. Off heat, whisk in butter, vanilla seeds and salt.
4. Stand apple halves upright on their edges in tight concentric circles — pack more than looks reasonable; they shrink.
5. Cook on the hob over medium heat 15–20 min, until the caramel bubbles up amber and the apples yield at the edges.
6. Cap with the pastry disc, tucking the edge down inside the pan.
7. Bake at 190 °C for 35–40 min until the pastry is deep gold and crisp.
8. Rest exactly 10 min; place a plate over and invert with commitment. Rearrange any strays; spoon stray caramel over.

PLATING & SERVICE

Warm wedges with cold crème fraîche — the temperature contrast is the dessert.

VARIATIONS & SWAPS

Pear tatin: firm Conference pears, add 2 g black pepper to the caramel. Quince + apple in winter is glorious.

Allergens: gluten, dairy

Recipe by Adrian Stefan, Table d'Adrian

Not medical advice. Talk to your doctor before changing your diet or training, especially if you have a medical condition or take medication.

DESSERTS

Mousse au Chocolat Noir 70 Pourcent

Serves 6 · Prep 25 min · Cook 5 min

"The French-family mousse — whole eggs, real chocolate, no cream in sight; four ingredients balanced so the chocolate does all the talking."

FROM THE RECIPE NOTES

INGREDIENTS (SERVES 6)

- Dark chocolate, 70% — 200 g
- Unsalted butter — 50 g
- Eggs, very fresh, separated — 6 (yolks 120 g, whites 180 g)
- Caster sugar — 40 g
- Fine salt — 1.5 g
- Espresso (optional) — 20 ml
- Cocoa nibs, to finish — 15 g

METHOD

1. Melt chocolate and butter over a bain-marie to 45 °C; stir in espresso; cool to 38 °C.
2. Beat yolks into the chocolate one by one — the mix will thicken and gloss.
3. Whip whites with salt to soft foam; rain in sugar; continue to soft, droopy peaks — NOT stiff (stiff whites make dry mousse).
4. Whisk one-third of the whites into the chocolate to lighten it.
5. Fold in the rest in two additions with a spatula, cutting to the bottom — stop at the last streak.
6. Pour into a large bowl or six glasses; chill 4 h minimum.
7. Finish with cocoa nibs and a few salt flakes.

PLATING & SERVICE

One big bowl passed around the table with a serving spoon is the true French way.

VARIATIONS & SWAPS

Orange zest or 10 ml Grand Marnier in the base. Uses raw eggs — source impeccably or use pasteurised for vulnerable guests.

Allergens: dairy, eggs

Recipe by Adrian Stefan, Table d'Adrian

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DESSERTS

Mont Blanc aux Marrons, Meringue Croquante

Serves 6 · Prep 45 min · Cook 90 min

"Crisp meringue, unsweetened chantilly and a summit of chestnut vermicelli — the autumn peak of French patisserie, piped to order."

FROM THE RECIPE NOTES

INGREDIENTS (SERVES 6)

Meringue: egg whites 3 (90 g), caster sugar 90 g, icing sugar 90 g, salt 1 g

Chestnut cream: sweetened chestnut purée (crème de marrons) 300 g, unsweetened chestnut purée 150 g, soft butter 60 g, dark rum 20 ml

Chantilly: double cream 300 ml, vanilla 1/2 pod (NO sugar — balance against the sweet chestnut)

Candied chestnuts, crumbled — 60 g

Icing sugar — 10 g

METHOD

1. Meringue: whip whites and salt to soft peaks; rain in caster sugar to stiff gloss; fold in sifted icing sugar.
2. Pipe six 8 cm domed discs; bake at 100 °C for 90 min until dry and lift-off clean; cool in the oven.
3. Chestnut cream: beat both purées with soft butter and rum until completely smooth; pass through a fine sieve (essential for clean strands); load into a piping bag with a multi-hole 'vermicelli' tip (or fine plain tip).
4. Whip the cream with vanilla to firm peaks.
5. Build: meringue base, a tall dome of chantilly (pipe or spoon), a few candied chestnut pieces hidden inside.
6. Pipe chestnut vermicelli over the dome in loops, covering the cream like a mountainside.
7. Dust the summit with icing sugar — the snowcap.

PLATING & SERVICE

Assembled to order (meringue softens in 2 h); serve on cold plates with strong coffee.

VARIATIONS & SWAPS

Blackcurrant coulis hidden under the chantilly cuts the richness beautifully. Store meringues airtight up to a week.

Allergens: dairy, eggs, nuts

Recipe by Adrian Stefan, Table d'Adrian

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